



Above The Dugald Stewart monument on Calton Hill overlooking the city of Edinburgh

A Day in Edinburgh

The Scottish capital runs over seven hills, so there are plenty of places to get a good overview of the city and its glorious surroundings.

MORNING Immerse yourself in 1,500 years of Scottish history at **Edinburgh Castle** on its towering rock above **Princes Street Gardens**. Other high points are **Calton Hill**, with its smattering of monuments, and **Arthur's Seat**, which looks down on Holyrood Palace and the modern architecture of the Scottish Parliament.

AFTERNOON Enjoy modern art in imposing 18th-century surrounds at the **Dean Gallery** and **Scottish National Gallery of Modern Art**, which face each other across sculpture-dotted parkland. Then take a peaceful walk through the **Royal Botanic Garden**. This verdant paradise includes the largest collection of Chinese plants outside Asia, a highland Heath Garden, and a towering 19th-century Palm House.

EVENING See Edinburgh's dark past at **The Real Mary King's Close**, a subterranean warren of 17th-century streets where actors bring long-dead former citizens back to life.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Edinburgh's **international airport** has flights from European cities; Glasgow Airport, 60 miles (96 km) away, has flights from long-haul departure points. There are **taxis** and a **bus** shuttle service to downtown Edinburgh.

WHERE TO STAY

Albyn Town House (inexpensive) is a graceful Victorian house with hearty Scottish breakfasts. www.albyntownhouse.co.uk

Hotel Du Vin (moderate) in the Old Town is a former asylum turned into a calm haven, with a whiskey snug. www.hotelduvin.com

The Witchery (expensive) is a 16th-century gem by Edinburgh Castle with opulently theatrical suites. www.thewitchery.com

TOURIST INFORMATION
www.visitscotland.com



Above The Edinburgh International Festival runs alongside its famous younger brother – the Fringe Festival – for three weeks in late summer